STOP!

By Ray Nesrym, © 2010

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The Intriguing Interp Series
is published by
Mushroom Cloud Press
Orlando, FL

For more information and performance rights, contact
Mushroom Cloud Press
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Lake Mary, FL 32746
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http://www.mushroomcloudpress.com/

ISSN listed in graphic seal below.



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MOM. Are you sure you're ready for this?

CHILD. Mom the driver's ed instructor said I was one of the best students in my class.

MOM. So you think you can do this?

CHILD. I'm sure I can do this, now will you give me the keys?

MOM. (reluctantly)Ok... Wait! What if you crash! You won't crash will you?

CHILD. MOM!

MOM. Alright here you go. (hands over keys) Ok now go ahead and buckle you're seatbelt, then adjust your mirrors…and the seat…Oh! And don't forget your wheel…Um… Are you sure that's low enough? I think the wheel should be lower.

CHILD. Mom it's fine how it is.

MOM. It looks a little high… are you sure you don't want it lower?

CHILD. Yes I'm sure, now buckle your seatbelt,

MOM. Why?

CHILD. In case we crash

MOM. Are you gonna crash? Maybe you shouldn't drive yet

CHILD. Mom calm down. I'm not gonna crash, now are you ready to go?

MOM. Ok, now the next thing you do is start the car.

CHILD. Really, I had no idea.(starts car and changes gear)

MOM. Well dear that's why I'm here, Now go ahead and put it in reverse

CHILD. Already done

MOM. Oh…ok, then go ahead and start pulling out of the drive way…Wait! Make sure no one's behind you first. Ok you can go. Woah! Slow down we aren't in a hurry….Watch out for the mailbox!

CHILD. (while backing up) Mom, calm down. I'm just pulling out of the driveway.

MOM. Sorry...Don't forget to start turning!

CHILD. (while turning) Mom, I got it ok?

MOM. Ok, go ahead and (gulp) put it in drive

CHILD. Gladly (changes gears)

MOM. (worried leaning to left) Um you need to stay a little more to the right dear….Woah!(moves away form the window) not that far right!...Whew! that was close, you could've hit a mailbox or something.

CHILD. Mom there's not a single mailbox on this road how could I possibly hit one!

MOM. Well if there was one you might've hit it!

CHILD. But there wasn't

MOM. But what if there was! You're driving now, you've really got to be thinking about these things!

CHILD. (annoyed) Of course mother

MOM. Now why are you going so slow the speed limit is twenty-five and you're going fifteen.

CHILD. I'm going twenty

MOM. Oh, well you can still go a little faster.

CHILD. Fine

MOM. Careful though!!! You don't want to go to fast!

CHILD. (sarcastically)Really I didn't know that

MOM. Are you being sarcastic?

CHILD. (with more sarcasm) Nope not at all.

MOM. So they didn't teach you not to drive to fast in drivers ed?-

CHILD. Mom, I was kidding

MOM. Oh…well it wasn't very funny…Um… I think you should probably start slowing down.

CHILD. Why?

MOM. There's a stop sign ahead, Don't you see it?

CHILD. (confused)No…?

MOM. (worried clutching dash board) Oh my god! You don't see the stop sign! What kind of a driver are you?

CHILD. What stop sign are you talking about?

MOM. The one ahead of us, down by the school.

CHILD. Wait, the school? We aren't even near there, Heck I can't even see the school yet.

MOM. Well you should know it's coming up and be prepared for it

CHILD. Fine I will be prepared for it, when we get there.

MOM. No, you need to start slowing down now so you can stop completely.

CHILD. Are *you* being sarcastic?

MOM. Of course not! Now are you gonna slow down or what?

CHILD. Fine

MOM. Now slow down, slower, slower! Keep slowing, more, more, you're getting there, slower, almost!

CHILD. Mom, we aren't going to get anywhere at five miles-per-hour.

MOM. Just Keep going, but slower. AAaannnddddd…STOP(hits imaginary break) Whew, now let this guy go since he has the right-of-way… Ok go ahead, Good job.

CHILD. Good job? Did I actually do something to meet your standards?

MOM. Well… Close enough, you could've stopped sooner, but it's no big deal, just make sure from now on when you stop the front of the car is behind the sign, not next to it.

CHILD. (sarcastically) Of course

MOM. There's another stop sign up ahead, lets see if you can do this one by yourself.

CHILD. Ok…lets see… (mockingly)Now slow down, slower, slower, keep slowing. More, more, you're getting there, slower, almost, just keep going, but slower, aaaannnnnddddd…stop. How was that?

MOM. You need to pull up more so you can see farther down the road.

CHILD. What next.

MOM. WATCH OUT! There's a red light coming up.

CHILD. Mom, it's green

MOM. No, the one after that!

CHILD. But, I'm not there yet. Shouldn't I worry about the one coming up first.

MOM. You're right

CHILD. Oh no

MOM. What?

CHILD. Are you sick? You just said I was right!

MOM. Well, you are right, since you're still a new driver we should try and make sure you don't worry about to much a once, it might confuse you. So just worry about the green light ahead,

CHILD. It turned red already.

MOM. Oh no! slow down (covering eyes) you need to stop! Don't hit the car in front of you!

CHILD. (rolls eyes and stops car) Can I turn on the radio?

MOM. Of course not! It would distract you and you might end up crashing.

CHILD. You're right, one big distraction is enough

MOM. exactly….wait a second-

CHILD. (quickly) Light's green lets go

MOM. Turn right up here

CHILD. Ok I have to change lanes first though.

MOM. oh! Wait a second! (rolls down window looks out) Ok you can go

CHILD. Mom can you just calm down

MOM. No, not really, in fact I keep getting more worried. I think you should stop

CHILD. But there's not a stop sign or red light anywhere near. Why do I need to stop this time?

MOM. I didn't mean like that, I meant stop driving for the day.

CHILD. Why? What have I done now? Did I turn to sharp or something?

MOM. Actually yes you did, but that's not why I want you to stop. I'm just nervous. I don't want anything to happen

CHILD. Mom, nothing's happened yet. I haven't even done anything really dangerous yet. I mean-

MOM. Wait…what do mean yet, were you planning on doing something dangerous?

CHILD. Of course not

MOM. Sorry, I'm just not ready for you to drive yet. Um… could you turn into this parking lot… Slow down!!!! You're turning too fast! You need to slow down when you turn, or you could flip teh car over or something!... Now could you park between that red van and black truck? You know how to park right?

CHILD. Yes mom.

MOM. Ok go ahead then…Turn sharper!!!! Now watch your sides…Straighten it! Straighten it!!... Now pull forward, a little more, no that's too much you need to go back!

CHILD. Mom, it doesn't have to be perfect, we're just switching seats.

MOM. Fine, well go ahead and put it in park then.

CHILD. Ok…I'm gonna leave the keys in alright?

MOM. What if someone tries to steal the car?

CHILD. Mom, we're just switching seats, we aren't even really leaving the car.

MOM. Fine, lets go (they switch seats) You know you're supposed to walk around behind the car not in front of it

CHILD. Does it matter?

MOM. Of course it does!

CHILD. Why?

MOM. Well… I don't remember, but it's for your own safety.

CHILD. of course it is

MOM. I know you wanted to keep driving, but I'm just really nervous. Maybe later you can drive with your father. (pulls out quickly)

CHILD. Woah , Mom… did you even look behind you before you pulled out?

MOM. Oh it's fine, I could tell there wasn't anyone behind me,

CHILD. How could you tell?

MOM. After you've driven as long as I have you can just tell.

CHILD. um…ok…

MOM. Now Why is that lady ahead of us going so slow? (honking horn)GET OFF THE ROAD GRANDMA!

CHILD. Um…mom? She's going the speed limit.

MOM. She's going slow!

CHILD. uh…I don't think you should be tailgating her like that.

MOM. You're right I can just pass her (turns wheel)

CHILD. MOM! You aren't supposed to go in that line. It's for the oncoming traffic.

MOM. Well there is no oncoming traffic now is there.

CHILD. …Um, there's a stop sign coming up and you're still going at least 15 miles over the speed limit.

MOM. Well, if there's no cop don't stop.

CHILD. I'm pretty sure that's not what the law says…Woah! Slow down! The light turned yellow!

MOM. It's fine, I can make it.

CHILD. I don't know if that's a good idea.

MOM. I know what I'm doing I've been driving for twenty-three years. Now if i want your opinion then I'll ask for it.

CHILD. But jsut because you've been driving for twenty-three years doesn't meanThat doesn't mean you can't-

CRASH!

CHILD. Way to go Mom, way to go.